



NITI Aayog

Strategy for

New India@75

STRATEGY FOR NEW INDIA @ 75

MODULE - 22

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

OBJECTIVES

The main objective is to maintain a clean, green and healthy environment with peoples' participation. The idea is by 2022-23, we should achieve certain goals.

AIR POLLUTION

- Eliminating crop residue burning.
- Bringing down PM2.5 levels in Indian cities to less than 50.
- Creating 175 GW of renewable energy generation capacity.
- Ensuring the coverage of all households with LPG for cooking.



SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT

Implementing effectively the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016.



OBJECTIVES

WATER POLLUTION

- Encouraging industries to utilize recycled/ treated water to the extent possible and ensuring zero discharge of untreated effluents from industrial units.
- Ensure Aviral and Nirmal Dhara in the Ganga, Yamuna and other rivers



FORESTRY

- Increasing the forest cover to 33.3% of the geographical area, as envisaged in the National Forest Policy, 1988.
- Improving the quality of existing forests.
- Encouraging Farm Forestry.



22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

PRESENT SCENARIO



- CPCB has identified 302 polluted river stretches on 275 rivers.
- The total polluted riverine length is 12,363 km.
- Indian cities face a high risk of air pollution.
- The rise in air pollution can be attributed to rapid industrialization, high urbanization, increased use of vehicles, uncontrolled burning of crop residue, emissions from coal power plants and brick kilns etc.

PRESENT SCENARIO



Ministry of Environment,
Forest and Climate Change
Government of India



- In March 2018, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change came up with the Draft National Forest Policy, 2018.
- The 1894 and 1952 versions of the forest policy largely focused on the production and revenue generation aspects.
- The National Forest Policy of 1988, for the first time, focused on environmental sustainability.
- The new forest policy aims to increase the share of forest and tree cover to 33.3%.
- Out of the total land area under forest cover, about 40% has only 10 to 40% canopy density.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

PRESENT SCENARIO

SOLID WASTE GENERATION



- Solid waste generation and its treatment is the pressing concern.
- In 2016, the Govt. estimated an annual waste generation of 62 million tonnes in the country, including 5.6 million tonnes of plastic waste, 0.17 million tonnes of bio-medical waste, 7.90 million tonnes of hazardous waste and 1.5 million tonnes of e-waste.
- Of this, only 22 to 28% was processed and treated.

Strategies for achieving sustainable environment



Learning Space

KEY PILLARS FOR SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT



22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

CONSTRAINTS

6 Agro-forestry is hampered by regulatory restrictions. Besides, biodiversity conservation and maintenance of healthy habitats for wild life have to be aligned with sustainability goals.

5 'Polluters should pay for the pollution' principle is not effectively implemented.

4 It is becoming difficult to bring about the behavioural change.

CONSTRAINTS
FOR ENSURING
SUSTAINABLE
ENVIRONMENT

1 The major contributor of air pollution in North India is the burning of crop residue.

2 Convincing farmers to discontinue the practice is a key challenge.

3 Lack of awareness with regard to the ill effects of pollution impedes the efforts to control pollution.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

1

CROP RESIDUE BURNING

- Extend financial support to farmers in the short-term for in-situ treatment of paddy-straw/non-burning of crop residue.
- Create a “Clean Air Impact Fund” to provide Viability Gap Funding for projects with long gestation periods and low returns on investment, such as bio-power or bio-ethanol projects.
- Upscale technologies for crop harvesting and utilization of farm residue.
- There should be a reward scheme for village panchayats with zero burning.

- Provide regulatory support for business models to crop residue utilization.
- Create awareness amongst the farmers for better soil management practices.



22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

2

SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT AND
AIR, WATER AND SOIL POLLUTION

- Effective implementation of Solid Waste Management Rules, will help achieve environmental sustainability by 2022-23.
- Continued efforts on the Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana is necessary.
- The scheme has already met with resounding success and it is recommended that continued efforts be made to prevent any slippage back to cooking using solid bio mass.
- Task Force should be constituted to control pollution from brick kilns.
- Emission and effluent standards for industries are to be revised and effectively implemented.

- Sewage treatment plants of adequate capacity should be installed at suitable locations to make rivers pollution free.



22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

2

SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT AND
AIR, WATER AND SOIL POLLUTION

- Wastewater discharge from industrial units into rivers and other water bodies should be reduced to zero.
- The use of bio-digester toilets, a technology licensed by the DRDO, may be expeditiously considered for nationwide implementation and if successful, it can do away with the need to have sewers and sewage treatment plants.
- Introduce an eco-labelling scheme to promote the sale of products made out of waste.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

3

FOREST MANAGEMENT

- Afforestation should be promoted aggressively through joint forest management (peoples' participation) and the involvement of the private sector.
- Highly denuded forests and wastelands could be leased to the private sector for specified periods for afforestation.
- Participation of people, particularly those dependent on forests for their livelihood, may also be encouraged.
- Public land available along railway tracks, highways, canals can be used for greening India.

- States and UTs may consider exemption of trees grown on private farmland from permit/transit pass.
- Revenue record and geo-tagging should be used to verify the origin of wood and wood-based products to identify species extracted from farm forestry.
- The new National Forest Policy, should be expeditiously implemented after taking comments from states/ concerned ministries.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

3

FOREST MANAGEMENT



- The boundaries of national parks and wildlife sanctuaries, which cover more than 5% of the country's geographical area, need to be protected.
- We should undertake measures to convert vacant spaces in urban areas into urban green areas. This facilitates increase in the overall tree cover in the country, which is presently 2.85% of the geographical area.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

4

CLIMATE CHANGE

GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND

- By 2030, 40% of cumulative power generation capacity installed should be non-fossil fuel based.
- Access to low cost finance, especially through the Green Climate Fund should be encouraged.
- In the light of new scientific information and technological advances, review all eight national missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change.
- New national missions on wind energy, waste-to-energy and coastal areas should be developed.

22

SUSTAINABLE ENVIRONMENT

WAY FORWARD

4

CLIMATE CHANGE



- The National Water Mission should be re-designed for efficient water resource management.
- Sustainable Agriculture should be redesigned to increase agricultural productivity and contribute significantly to achieve the vision of doubling farmers' income by 2022-23.
- Use the National Adaptation Fund for Climate Change for strengthening resilience against climate change in sectors like agriculture, forestry, infrastructure and others.

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